

THE MODERN BRAIN

The modern lifestyle's effect on our minds

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DECLINING MEMORY



A recent study published in the journal *SLEEP* titled, *Insomnia disorder increases the risk of subjective memory decline in middle-aged and older adults: a longitudinal analysis of the Canadian Longitudinal Study on Aging*, has found out that insomnia increases the chances of memory loss in older adults. The co-lead author of this study, Nathan Cross, said: "We found that insomnia specifically was related to worse memory performance compared to those who have some insomnia symptoms alone or no sleep problems at all."

During the course of this research, the subjects were divided into the following three categories:

- People who reported no problems in their sleeping patterns
- People who had some insomnia symptoms
- People who had developed probable insomnia

Before starting out, they had set a baseline at the figures and observations reported in 2019. And after the segregation, they compared the reports from 2022. The people who were in the latter two categories of the three that is - people who had some insomnia symptoms and people who had developed probable insomnia symptoms, were the ones who had a clinically diagnosed memory loss problem, or reported it themselves. The researchers also pointed out that "They (people from the latter two categories) were also more likely to show higher prevalence of anxiety, depression, daytime sleepiness, have breathing interruptions during sleep, other sleep-related issues, smoking and a greater body mass index (BMI) score."

All hope is not lost, though, as the researchers also told that sleep disorders like insomnia could be treated. However, a crucial element that remains is the diagnosis of the disorders, which needs to happen at an early stage for their treatment to go ahead effectively.

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